

1.9 Choosing A Blogging Platform And Host

To understand what features constitute a good platform it is best to revert to our earlier discussion on making the most of the blogosphere as a visitor. We can conclude that the following features can be considered as visitor friendly:

- 1. Font Characteristics:** Fonts should be large enough so that the visitors do not have to squint to read the content. Font colours for normal text and links should be such as to allow sufficient contrast with the background.
- 2. Page Style:** Garishly coloured pages are a put off; not many like to read red text off a bright yellow page. But if the mood of the blogger is a happy one, using a gloomy grey would also make it difficult to connect with the reader.
- 3. Page Layout:** The reading experience should not be marred by an obstructive layout. Inserting ads right in the middle of the post text is generally a bad idea, as is the practice of using a very narrow post column leading to lot of scrolling. Having links to important pages at the very bottom of a long page is as good as not having them at all.
- 4. Page Content:** Extraneous content can be blighting. While ads are a conspicuous bloat, there are other less noticeable irritants. A blog can be bogged down by the number of comments posted by visitors. A page containing a two-sentence post followed by 100 comments will take time to load, testing the visitor's patience. Visitors to the site are more interested in what the blogger has to say. SPAM messages that are not promptly weed-out from the comments leave a bad impression. A page containing 10 posts will not only take time to load, but also will increase the time taken to dig down to the interesting post. Having one page per post would preclude this effort.

Putting up large images or links to them without offering a